CHAPTER 1

Butter Candle Classics

These are the candles I make most often: simple, quick, and impossible to stop dipping into. Most use the Direct Wick method because their mix-ins are fine enough to sit right up against the flame. Master two or three of them and you'll always have a centerpiece ready for unexpected guests.

RECIPES 1–15

RECIPE 001

V GF NF

Classic Sea Salt Butter Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Direct Wick • Active 15 minutes • Chill 2 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

This is the candle that started it all, and the one to make first. Good butter, a little flaky salt and nothing else: it lets the bread and the butter shine, and it teaches you the rhythm of packing, wicking and chilling that every other recipe builds on.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (2 sticks / 227 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)
- 1 teaspoon flaky sea salt (2 g), plus more for sprinkling
- 1 primed food-safe wick



METHOD

1. In a medium bowl, beat the butter with a flexible spatula until smooth and creamy, about 1 minute. Beat in the fine sea salt until evenly distributed. Gently fold in the flaky salt so the crystals stay whole.
2. **Pack and wick.** Pack the butter into a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold in three additions, pressing and tapping out air, to ½ in (12 mm) below the rim. Push a chopstick down the center to ½ in (12 mm) from the bottom and slide in a primed wick.
3. **Chill** for 2 hours, until the skewer test shows it is firm throughout.
4. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> FIRST-TRY TIP Use the best butter you can find here; with so few ingredients, it is the flavor. A European-style butter with 82% fat or more gives the smoothest, glossiest finish.

PAIR

Crusty sourdough, a warm baguette, or the No-Knead Crusty Bread Bowl (Bread B1).

SERVE

Sprinkle a few extra flakes of salt on top just after lighting so they glitter in the melting pool. Serve with radishes and cucumber spears for a fresh contrast.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 030

V GF NF

Three-Herb Garden Layered Candle

Makes 1 tall layered candle • Serves 10 to 12 • Layered • Active 35 minutes • Chill 3 hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

Three bands of color (parsley green, golden thyme and pale chive) stacked one on top of another. It's the showpiece of the chapter and much easier than it looks.

INGREDIENTS

For the base

- 1½ cups (3 sticks / 340 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 1 teaspoon fine sea salt (5 g)

For the layers

- 2 tablespoons finely chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tablespoon fresh thyme leaves, chopped, plus finely grated zest of ½ lemon
- 1 tablespoon finely sliced fresh chives
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core



METHOD

1. Beat the butter with the salt until creamy. Divide it equally among three bowls (about 115 g each). Fold the parsley into the first bowl, the thyme and lemon zest into the second, and the chives into the third.
2. Grease a wide straw with a little clarified butter and stand it in the center of a tall 16 oz (475 ml) paper cup or pillar mold. Pack the parsley butter around the straw, pressing firmly and tapping the mold. Smooth the top and chill for 15 minutes.
3. Pack the thyme butter on top, smooth, and chill for 15 minutes. Finish with the chive layer, smooth the top and chill for 1½ hours.
4. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
5. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

FIRST-TRY TIP The short chills between layers keep the lines crisp. Pack each new layer gently at first, so you don't press it into the soft layer beneath.

PAIR

A basket of mixed sourdough, rye and baguette.

SERVE

Unmold it in front of your guests: the reveal of the three layers is half the fun.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 5 days in the fridge or 2 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.

RECIPE 103

V GF NF

Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle

Makes 1 standard candle • Serves 6 to 8 • Clean-Burn Core • Active 20 minutes • Chill 2½ hours • Burn about 45 to 60 minutes

This is the base candle for the chapter: rich, dark and silky, with a scattering of flaky salt to make the chocolate taste even deeper. It's simple, sophisticated and endlessly dippable.

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup (1½ sticks / 170 g) unsalted butter, softened to 65°F (18°C)
- 3 oz (85 g) dark chocolate (60 to 70% cocoa), finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons powdered sugar (16 g)
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt (1 g)
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt, to finish
- 1 primed food-safe wick
- 2 tablespoons (25 g) clarified butter or ghee, for the core



METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate and cool it to 88 to 90°F (31 to 32°C), following the Chocolate Candle Base.
2. Beat the butter with the powdered sugar, vanilla and fine salt until light and creamy. With the mixer on low, pour in the chocolate in a steady stream and beat for 1 minute more, until glossy.
3. After lighting the finished candle, sprinkle the flaky salt over the top so it melts into the pool.
4. **Pack around the core.** Stand a greased wide straw in the center of a standard 10 to 12 oz (300 to 350 ml) mold and pack the butter around it in three additions, pressing and tapping out air. Chill for 1½ hours.
5. **Make the Clean-Burn Core.** Twist out the straw, stand a primed wick in the channel and fill it with clarified butter cooled to 95 to 105°F (35 to 40°C). Chill 1 hour more, until firm throughout.
6. **Serve.** Unmold onto a heatproof plate, board or bread bowl, trim the wick to ¼ in (6 mm) and light. Dip once a pool forms, after 10 to 15 minutes.

> **FIRST-TRY TIP** Check the chocolate's temperature with a thermometer. It's the single detail that decides whether this candle turns out smooth or streaky.

PAIR

Strawberries, brioche, shortbread, or pretzel rods.

SERVE

Serve after dinner with fresh strawberries, orange segments, shortbread and a glass of red wine or port.

MAKE AHEAD

Wrapped, the unlit candle keeps up to 2 weeks in the fridge or 3 months in the freezer. Once lit, enjoy within the hour.